

The Noble Teaching on the Perfection of Wisdom Requested by Suvikrāntavikrama—kn

Toh 14 · Derge Kangyur

The Noble Teaching on the Perfection of Wisdom Requested by Suvikrāntavikrama—known in Sanskrit as the *Ārya Suvikrāntavikrama Paripṛcchā Prajñāpāramitā Nirdeśa* and in Tibetan as 'Phags pa rab kyi rtsal gyis rnam par gnon pas zhus pa shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa bstan pa—is a Mahāyāna sūtra belonging to the vast Prajñāpāramitā, or Perfection of Wisdom, literature. Set at Vulture Peak's Bamboo Grove near Rājagṛha, it opens with the Buddha surrounded by a great assembly of monks and bodhisattvas, before the bodhisattva Suvikrāntavikrama comes forward to pose questions that occasion the Buddha's teaching on the profound nature of wisdom's perfection. As is typical of this genre, the text likely explores themes of emptiness, non-attachment, and the bodhisattva path through dialogue between the Buddha and the questioning bodhisattva. This work is catalogued as Toh 14 in the Kangyur, placing it among the canonical discourses attributed directly to the Buddha, and it forms part of the broader Prajñāpāramitā section that constitutes one of the foundational bodies of Mahāyāna scripture.

In the language of India: *Ārya Suvikrāntavikrama Paripṛcchā Prajñāpāramitā Nirdeśa*.

In the language of Tibet: The Noble One's Teaching on the Perfection of Wisdom Requested by Suvikrāntavikrama. Volume one.

Homage to all buddhas, bodhisattvas, and noble hearers.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha, in the Karanda Bamboo Grove, together with a great saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks, and with bodhisattva great beings, immeasurable and innumerable, who had come together from various buddha realms, obstructed only by a single more birth. At that time the Blessed One, surrounded and faced by many hundreds of thousands of retinue members, was teaching the Dharma.

Then the bodhisattva great being named Suvikrāntavikrama, who had gathered in that very assembly and was seated there, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, and, bowing with palms joined toward the place where the Blessed One was, spoke thus to the Blessed One: "If, having asked, the Blessed One grants me

the opportunity to have my question answered, I would like to ask the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha, about a certain matter."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said this to the bodhisattva great being Suvikrāntavikrama: "Suvikrāntavikrama, ask the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha, whatever you wish, and I shall gladden your mind by answering whatever you ask."

When this had been said, the bodhisattva great being Suvikrāntavikrama spoke thus to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, as to what is called 'the perfection of wisdom, the perfection of wisdom' — Blessed One, to what extent is it called the perfection of wisdom of the bodhisattva great beings? Blessed One, how does a bodhisattva great being engage in the perfection of wisdom? Blessed One, how does the bodhisattva great being who engages in the perfection of wisdom bring the cultivation of the perfection of wisdom to full completion? Blessed One, how is it that when the bodhisattva great being cultivates the perfection of wisdom, the wicked Māra finds no opportunity, and moreover comes to understand all the deeds of Māra? Blessed One, abiding in what manner within the perfection of wisdom does the bodhisattva great being swiftly bring the qualities of omniscience to full completion?"

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke thus to the bodhisattva great being Suvikrāntavikrama: "Suvikrāntavikrama, for the sake of the bodhisattva great beings, and in order that you may benefit many people, bring happiness to many people, show compassion for the world, and act for the sake, benefit, and happiness of the great multitude of gods and humans, and because you wish to illuminate this for the bodhisattva great beings of the present and of the future, you have entered upon this — it is excellent, excellent that you ask the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha, about the perfection of wisdom!"

Not-knowing, too, should not be called gnosis. If not-knowing were to be called gnosis, then for that reason all ordinary childish beings would become possessors of gnosis. That which does not apprehend gnosis and not-knowing as separate, and which thoroughly knows gnosis and not-knowing exactly as they really are — that itself is called gnosis. Gnosis is not as it is expressed in words. Therefore gnosis is not to be expressed in words, and it utterly transcends every object; gnosis is not the object of anyone, nor is there any object of gnosis whatsoever.

Suvikrāntavikrāmin, this gnosis being taught here is neither an object nor a direction. Whoever knows this does not fall into the reckoning of being called "a possessor of gnosis" or "not a possessor of gnosis."

Suvikrāntavikrāmin, that which thus thoroughly knows, subsequently realizes, and fully comprehends is called discernment (prajñā). Suvikrāntavikrāmin, that which thus directly realizes and actualizes is called transcendent discernment — discernment that has gone beyond the world — but it is not as it is expressed in the words "transcend

This overcoming through supreme power is the thorough knowing of reality exactly as it is; therefore it is called freedom. Apart from this freedom from not-knowing and freedom from knowing, nothing else whatsoever is apprehended. Since even wisdom itself is not apprehended, what need is there to speak of the not-knowing that is liberated from what has been exhausted? Therefore it is called "knowledge of exhaustion" — yet it is not as the words themselves suggest. For that which is knowledge of exhaustion has no verbal designation that can be applied to it at all; nevertheless, it is taught in this way as "ignorance exhausted" and "knowledge of exhaustion."

Suvikrāntavikrāmin, one who through examination comprehends that all phenomena are both inexhaustible and yet the object of the knowledge of exhaustion is free from the knowledge of exhaustion, and subsequently attains the limit of what has no exhaustion. This limitlessness is the limit of nirvāṇa — yet it is not as the words themselves suggest. All phenomena are the limit of nirvāṇa, which is to say, the limitless. The cutting off of all limits is called "the limit of nirvāṇa" — yet it is not as the words themselves suggest. The limit of nirvāṇa is not to be expressed as the cutting off of all conventional designations.

Suvikrāntavikrāmin, this teaching of the expanse of nirvāṇa is likewise not as it is taught in words. Because it genuinely transcends every kind of teaching, the expanse of nirvāṇa cannot be taught; that cutting off of all teaching is what is called "the expanse of nirvāṇa." What is called "the expanse of nirvāṇa" applies to the teaching of the definitive realization of the wisdom that transcends the world. Suvikrāntavikrāmin, it is taught that this expanse of nirvāṇa does not abide in any object and does not abide in any direction.

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Ānanda, in just the same way, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, likewise sends down a great rain of Dharma. And those

foremost sons, the bodhisattva great beings, go forth from this world system each to his own buddha-field, and, having taken up this arising of all phenomena, in the presence of those Tathāgatas they too release and cause to pour down a great rain of Dharma.

Ānanda, it is like this. For example, when the nāga king of the ocean becomes greatly joyful, at that time he sends down a great stream of rain from his own abode. Those nāgas who dwell in that abode, receiving that stream of rain, become joyful, and by that stream of rain they know well-being. Those who are his sons likewise bear that stream of rain, and by that stream of rain they attain supreme joy. Why is this? Ānanda, it is because other nāgas cannot bear that stream of rain; other nāgas do not know well-being through that stream of rain, and they do not become joyful through those streams of rain.

Ānanda, in just the same way, those who are especially attached to the Dharma jewel of the Tathāgata, and those foremost sons of the Tathāgata, the bodhisattva great beings, who have created roots of virtue, whose intention is vast, and who have arisen definitively from the way of the profound Dharma—these can bear this great rain of the way of the Tathāgata's Dharma. Having heard it, they become greatly joyful and delighted, and know well-being through it.

Ānanda, relying upon this point of meaning, the Tathāgata roars the great lion's roar in the assembly of those of pure intention, and sends down a great rain of Dharma.

Ānanda, it is like this. For example, a wheel-turning king who possesses many accumulated treasures of jewels summons all his many sons who are of good lineage and pure on the mother's side as well, and, dividing the treasury of jewels among them, gives to each son without deceiving any of them. Having divided it thus, they, having conceived great joy and delight toward that wheel-turning king, think, "We have become equal in benefit to the wheel-turning king," and they know well-being themselves.

Ānanda, in just the same way, the Tathāgata, the King of Dharma, the self-arisen Lord of Dharma, likewise gathers together those sons and divides equally this treasury of the jewel of Dharma; and because he does not deceive any of those sons, they generate great joy, delight, and reverence toward me, and, their aims being in accord, they abide without breaking the lineage of the Buddha.

Ānanda, other sentient beings who are inferior, who delight in inferior things, who engage in views out of pride, who engage with signs, who engage with objects of reference, who are overcome by the pride that thinks "I," who are overpowered by the force of attachment, aversion, and delusion, and who have entered upon the wrong path—these are unable to bear this jewel of Dharma.

Ānanda, sentient beings who delight in inferior things do not desire the wealth of a wheel-turning king; but, Ānanda, those who have become the sons of a wheel-turning king do desire the wealth of a wheel-turning king.

Ānanda, impoverished sentient beings do not hold as necessary the precious wheel, the precious elephant, the precious horse, the precious jewel, the precious woman, the precious householder, the precious minister, many garments, gold, jewels, pearls, beryl, conch, crystal, coral, refined gold, and much silver; even if they obtain these, they are unable to enjoy them with delight, and they sell them cheaply, and, being unskilled, they discard them. Why is this?

Śāradvatīputra, this assembly was not gathered by the Tathāgata, and the Tathāgata makes no effort whatsoever with regard to it. Having heard my name through their own roots of virtue, this assembly came together. Without the Tathāgata ever having spoken to them or instructed them concerning this assembly, they arrived here at this assembly, spurred on by their own roots of virtue. That such great beings should gather for the teaching of such a Dharma as this is simply its nature of reality. Śāradvatīputra, for whatever other buddhas, blessed ones, correctly teach this Bodhisattva-piṭaka that cuts through all doubts, the assemblies of those teachers likewise gather in just this way. That such an assembly, such a maṇḍala of an assembly, should inevitably arise is the nature of reality of this teaching of the Dharma.

This concludes the second chapter, called "The Chapter of Ānanda."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva mahāsattva Suvikrāntavikrāmin (Supreme Valiant Stride): "Suvikrāntavikrāmin, as for what is called the Perfection of Wisdom — what is the bodhisattva's Perfection of Wisdom? It is the realization of the far shore of all phenomena. This cannot actually be taught, yet I will explain it in such a way that you may come to understand it, and in such a way that the Perfection of Wisdom may be expressed in conventional words.

"Form is not the Perfection of Wisdom, yet the Perfection of Wisdom is also not other than form. The same applies in turn: feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are not the Perfection of Wisdom, yet the Perfection of Wisdom is also not other than consciousness.

"Why is this? Suvikrāntavikrāmin, whatever is the far shore of form is not form. The same applies in turn: whatever is the far shore of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness is not consciousness.

"Just as is the far shore of form, so too is form itself. Likewise, just as is the far shore of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, so too is consciousness itself. Just as is the far shore of consciousness, so too are all phenomena. Whatever is the far shore of all phenomena is not all phenomena. Just as is the far shore of all phenomena, so too are all phenomena themselves.

"Suvikrāntavikrāmin, the statement that whatever is the far shore of form is not form teaches the separation from form. The statement that just as is the far shore of form, so too is form itself, teaches the explanation of the essential nature of form. That teaches the reality of form as it is. That teaches the intrinsic nature of form. That teaches the non-apprehensibility of form.

"Likewise, the statement that whatever is the far shore of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness is not consciousness teaches the separation from consciousness. The statement that just as is the far shore of consciousness,

That which is also not unpleasant — that too is the perfection of wisdom.

Suvikrāntavikrāmin (Skt. Suvikrāntavikrāmin, "Sup

Teaching meditative absorption and equipoise is not the Perfection of Wisdom. Rather, the suchness of the teaching of meditative concentration, liberation, absorption, and equipoise, the unmistakable suchness, the suchness that is not other, and the suchness of things just as they are—that is the Perfection of Wisdom. Its power thoroughly subdues.

Teaching the five superknowledges is not the Perfection of Wisdom. Rather, the suchness of the teaching of the five superknowledges, the unmistakable suchness, the suchness that is not other, and the suchness of things just as they are—that is the Perfection of Wisdom. Its power thoroughly subdues.

Teaching the conditioned, the wholesome and unwholesome phenomena of the world, and the accomplishment of manifest actualization of these, is not

the Perfection of Wisdom. Rather, the suchness of these, the unmistakable suchness, the suchness that is not other, and the suchness of things just as they are—that is the Perfection of Wisdom. Its power thoroughly subdues.

Teaching the applications of mindfulness, the correct exertions, the bases of miraculous power, the faculties, the powers, the branches of awakening, and the path, and the accomplishment of manifest actualization of these, is not the Perfection of Wisdom. Rather, the suchness of the teaching of the applications of mindfulness, the correct exertions, the bases of miraculous power, the faculties, the powers, the branches of awakening, and the path, and the accomplishment of manifest actualization of these, the unmistakable suchness, the suchness that is not other, and the suchness of things just as they are—that is the Perfection of Wisdom. Its power thoroughly subdues.

Teaching the four noble truths is not the Perfection of Wisdom. Rather, the suchness of the teaching of the four noble truths, the unmistakable suchness, the suchness that is not other, and the suchness of things just as they are—that is the Perfection of Wisdom. Its power thoroughly subdues.

Teaching the purified vision of moral discipline, meditative concentration, wisdom, liberation, and the wisdom that sees liberation is not the Perfection of Wisdom. Rather, the suchness of the teaching of the purified vision of moral discipline, meditative concentration, wisdom, liberation, and the wisdom that sees liberation, the unmistakable suchness, the suchness that is not other, and the suchness of things just as they are—that is the Perfection of Wisdom. Its power thoroughly subdues.

Teaching the phenomena that are unconditioned, that transcend the world, that are without abode, and that are undefiled is not the Perfection of Wisdom. Rather, this suchness of the teaching of the phenomena that are unconditioned, that transcend the world, that are without abode, and that are undefiled, the unmistakable suchness, the suchness that is not other, and the suchness of things just as they are—that is the Perfection of Wisdom. Its power thoroughly subdues.

Teaching emptiness, signlessness, wishlessness, non-arising, and the manifestly unconditioned phenomena is not the Perfection of Wisdom. Rather, the suchness of the teaching of emptiness, signlessness, wishlessness, non-arising, and the manifestly unconditioned phenomena, the unmistakable suchness, the suchness that is not other, and...

Because the reality of all phenomena cannot be shown, and because the knowing and seeing of all phenomena is not truly established, the perfection of wisdom is not truly established. Because becoming cool, peace, and utter peace are not truly established, the perfection of wisdom is not truly established. Because the ripening of sentient beings is not truly established, the perfection of wisdom is not truly established. Because the perfection of marks, the utterly pure buddha-field, the powers of a buddha, the fearlessnesses, and the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha are not truly established, the perfection of wisdom is not truly established. Because nirvāṇa is not truly established, the perfection of wisdom is not truly established. Because all phenomena, virtuous and non-virtuous, up to and including all of them, are not truly established, the perfection of wisdom is not truly established. Likewise this should be applied extensively to all things.

Śāriputra, it is like this: space, for example, has no form, cannot be shown, has no substance, and is not truly established. Likewise the perfection of wisdom also has no form, cannot be shown, has no substance, and is not truly established.

Śāriputra, it is like this: a rainbow, for example, appears with a variety of colors everywhere, yet not a single color in it is truly established; none can be apprehended. Likewise, although the perfection of wisdom is present as a variety of teachings, the intrinsic nature of that teaching cannot be apprehended.

Śāriputra, it is like this: never before has anyone seen five fingers truly established in space. Śāriputra, likewise, never before has anyone seen the intrinsic nature of the perfection of wisdom as truly established.

When this had been spoken, venerable Śāriputra said this to the Blessed One: Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom is difficult to see. The Blessed One said: Śāriputra, it is so — it does not draw near to being seen by anyone at all. Śāriputra said: Blessed One, the perfection of wisdom is difficult to fathom. The Blessed One said: Śāriputra, it is so — with respect to this, no phenomenon whatsoever that is truly established as fully and completely realized can be apprehended. Śāriputra said: Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom cannot be shown. The Blessed One said: Śāriputra, it is so — no phenomenon whatsoever abides so as to be shown. Śāriputra said: Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom has no intrinsic nature. The Blessed One said: Śāriputra, because form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness

have no intrinsic nature, this perfection of wisdom has no intrinsic nature. Because the elements, the sense sources, and dependent origination have no intrinsic nature, the perfection of wisdom has no intrinsic nature. Because error, obscuration, falling into views, and the engagement of craving have no intrinsic nature, the perfection of wisdom has no intrinsic nature. Because self, sentient being, life-force, nourisher, person, individual, one born of another, offspring, agent, one who causes to act, instigator, one who causes instigation, experiencer, and one who causes experience have no intrinsic nature, the perfection of wisdom has no intrinsic nature. Because earth, water, fire, wind, space, consciousness, and the element of phenomena have no intrinsic nature, the perfection of wisdom has no intrinsic nature.

He said, Blessed One, in what phenomenon does this perfection of wisdom abide, or upon what does it rest as a basis?

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, no phenomenon whatsoever is observed as that in which the perfection of wisdom abides or that which serves as its basis.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom does not abide fixed in clinging to any phenomenon whatsoever.

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, no phenomenon whatsoever is observed as that to which the perfection of wisdom would cling.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom does not abide fixed in excessive attachment to any phenomenon whatsoever.

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, no phenomenon whatsoever is truly seen as that to which the perfection of wisdom would be excessively attached.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom does not abide fixed either in abiding with any phenomenon or in not abiding.

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, no phenomenon whatsoever is observed as that together with which the perfection of wisdom abides.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom does not abide fixed either in being joined to any phenomenon or in not being joined.

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, no phenomenon whatsoever is observed as that which the perfection of wisdom would join or not join.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom does not abide fixed in attachment or in freedom from attachment to any phenomenon whatsoever.

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, no phenomenon whatsoever is observed as that to which the perfection of wisdom would become attached or unattached.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom does not abide fixed in aversion or in freedom from aversion toward any phenomenon whatsoever.

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, no phenomenon whatsoever is observed as that toward which the perfection of wisdom would have aversion or be without aversion.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom does not abide fixed in delusion or in freedom from delusion regarding any phenomenon whatsoever.

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, no phenomenon whatsoever is observed as that regarding which the perfection of wisdom would be deluded or not become deluded.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom is not the knower of any phenomenon, nor does it perform the act of knowing.

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, no phenomenon whatsoever is observed as something the perfection of wisdom knows, or as a phenomenon that would cause any phenomenon to be known.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom does not abide fixed either as the intrinsic nature of any phenomenon or as its absence of intrinsic nature.

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, neither the intrinsic nature of any phenomenon nor the absence of intrinsic nature is truly seen as belonging to the perfection of wisdom.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom does not abide fixed either in the purity or the thorough purity of any phenomenon.

He replied, Śāriputra, in this way, no phenomenon whatsoever is truly seen as something the perfection of wisdom purifies or thoroughly purifies.

He said, Blessed One, this perfection of wisdom is thoroughly pure by its very nature.

He replied, Śāradvatīputra, because form is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Śāriputra, because feeling, perception, formations,

Because consciousness is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Śāriputra, because ignorance is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because formations are thoroughly pure, consciousness is thoroughly

pure, name and form are thoroughly pure, and the six sense sources are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because contact, feeling, craving, grasping, becoming, birth, aging, sickness, and death are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because grief, lamentation, suffering, mental unhappiness, and disturbance are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because error, obscuration, and mistaken views are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because attachment, aversion, and delusion are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because self, sentient being, life-force, nourished one, person, individual, one born of another, offspring, agent, one who causes action, experiencer, one who causes experience, instigator, one who thoroughly instigates, and observer are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because annihilation and permanence are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the extreme and the absence of extremes are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because generosity is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the faculties, the powers, the branches of awakening, the concentrations, the liberations, the meditative absorptions, and the equipoises are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the applications of mindfulness and the correct abandonments are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because non-erroneousness is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because suffering, origin, cessation, and the path are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the higher knowledges are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the path is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the śrāvakas are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the ground of the pratyekabuddhas is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the ground of the buddhas is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the seeing of the past, the future, and the present is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because unobstructed wisdom is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the eighteen unmixed qualities of a buddha are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm are thoroughly pure, the perfection of

wisdom is pure. Because the earth element is thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure. Because the water, fire, and wind elements are thoroughly pure, the perfection of wisdom is pure.

Because the applications of mindfulness are infinite, and the correct exertions, the bases of miraculous power, the faculties, the powers, and the limbs of awakening are infinite, and the unmistaken factors are infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because the concentrations, the liberations, the meditative absorptions, and the equipoises are infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because the objects of focus are infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because the vision of the wisdom of knowledge and liberation is infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because the grounds of the śrāvakas and the grounds of the pratyekabuddhas are infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because the doctrines of the śrāvakas, the doctrines of the pratyekabuddhas, and the doctrines of the buddhas are infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because the self and sentient beings are infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because the desire realm is infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because the form realm and the formless realm are infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because the higher cognitions are infinite, and the obscurations are infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because the vision of the wisdom of the past, the future, and the present is infinite, this perfection is infinite. Because non-attachment is infinite, and space is infinite, and the dharmadhātu is infinite, this perfection is infinite.

Śāriputra, the perfection of wisdom cannot be apprehended at its beginning, middle, or end. It cannot be apprehended by anything whatsoever. Śāriputra, it is like this: this perfection of wisdom is infinite and without limit. It is like this: just as the limit of space cannot be apprehended, so too the limit of the perfection of wisdom cannot be apprehended. Because the element of earth is infinite, the perfection of wisdom should be seen as infinite. Because the element of water, the element of fire, the element of wind, the element of space, and the element of consciousness are infinite, the perfection of wisdom should be understood as infinite. Śāriputra, the perfection of wisdom should be understood as without end, without center, and without limit.

Śāriputra, thus the perfection of wisdom does not abide in any object, and does not abide in any direction. Śāriputra, because form is without limit, the perfection of wisdom should be known as without limit. It is to be applied likewise: because feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are without limit, the perfection of wisdom should be known as without limit. From ignorance without limit up to aging and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering,

mental unease, and disturbance without limit, Śāriputra, the perfection of wisdom should be known as without limit. Because error is without limit, obscuration is without limit, and the arising of views is without limit, Śāriputra, the perfection of wisdom should be known as without limit. Because the self is without limit, and sentient beings are without limit, the perfection of wisdom should be known as without limit. Because generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom are without limit, the perfection of wisdom should be known as without limit. Because the applications of mindfulness and the correct exertions are without limit, the perfection of wisdom should be known as without limit. Because the faculties, the powers, the limbs of awakening, the concentrations, the liberations, the meditative absorptions, and the equipoises are without limit, the perfection of wisdom should be known as without limit. Śāriputra, because suffering, origin, cessation, and

Śāriputra, even those sentient beings in whose ears this teaching of the Dharma is merely heard are not possessed of only a small root of virtue—how much more so those who take it up, uphold it, read it, and thoroughly master it! Such beings are indeed prophesied by the buddhas, the blessed ones, to attain the Dharma of buddhahood. Just as I now roar the lion's roar, the sound of fearlessness, the sound of the great being, the naturally arisen sound, so too will they roar the lion's roar.

Even for those who merely generate faith in this Dharma, and thereby generate aspiration for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, that very generation of aspiration is itself their prophecy. Why is this? Śāriputra, sentient beings who, having heard this profound Dharma, generate joy, supreme joy, and heartfelt conviction—such beings are extremely difficult to find. Śāriputra, even more difficult to find than that are sentient beings who, having heard this profound Dharma, generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening and generate heartfelt conviction—those endowed with great virtue are exceedingly rare to find.

Śāriputra, if I did not declare that even those sentient beings in whose ears this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom comes to be heard, and who, having heard it, read it, develop conviction, joy, and great mental happiness, and generate aspiration for this Dharma for the sake of hearing it again and again—if I did not declare that even such beings have entered into the great cycle of existence (saṃsāra), how much more so those who receive it as scriptural transmission, recite it, and teach it to others! Śāriputra, those who

are not definitely established in, and are uncertain about, the vehicle of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas—these I prophesy to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Śāriputra, I do not see any opportunity for sentient beings endowed with inferior qualities to receive this supreme Dharma. Śāriputra, this awakening of the buddhas is vast, yet most sentient beings incline toward the inferior and are endowed with inferior qualities; they have not cultivated virtue with respect to such a profound, non-attached Dharma as this, and are unskilled in it.

Śāriputra, this Dharma is for those sentient beings who are vast, who incline toward the vast Dharma, who have genuinely entered the Great Vehicle, who have thoroughly attained its true purpose, who are thoroughly arrayed in great armor, who have excellently realized its meaning, and who have entered upon the great path—straight, without terror, free of thickets, level, without mirage or thorns, without precipice or chasm, pure, harmless, without crookedness, and without deviation.

Śāriputra, those who benefit the world, who bring happiness to the world, who feel tender compassion for the world, who have entered for the welfare, benefit, and happiness of gods and humans, who illuminate sentient beings, who have become a guide (tīrthika, here meaning "ford" or "crossing point") for beings, who possess great compassion, who feel tender compassion aimed at benefit, who wish to benefit, who wish for happiness, who wish for accomplishment and happiness, and who abide close by, applying all sentient beings to happiness—such bodhisattva great beings are the great treasure of these sentient beings.

Śāriputra, these great beings seek this precious Dharma; this indeed is their sublime treasure. Why is this? Śāriputra, sentient beings who have not created merit, who incline toward the inferior, and whose faith has utterly degenerated do not generate conviction in this vast treasure of Dharma. Śāriputra, with this in mind I have taught: sentient beings who incline toward the inferior are, according to their disposition, matched with inclination toward the inferior; and those who incline toward the vast are, according to their disposition, matched with inclination toward the vast.

Then venerable Śāradvatīputra addressed the Blessed One thus: Blessed One, what is the domain of the Perfection of Wisdom? Having spoken thus, the Blessed One said this to venerable Śāradvatīputra:

Do bodhisattvas who are subdued by supreme power course in the observation of the perfect purity of the marks? Do they course in the observation of the perfect purity of a buddha field? Do they course in the observation of the perfection of śrāvakas? If they course in the observation of the perfection of bodhisattvas, then they are not coursing in the perfection of wisdom. Why is that? Because for them, the observation of the perfect purity of the marks, the observation of the perfect purity of a buddha field, the observation of the perfection of śrāvakas, and the observation of the perfection of bodhisattvas are utterly destroyed. As for that which is utterly destroyed, there is no coursing whatsoever in it. Therefore, this absence of coursing is called the coursing of a bodhisattva.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way is coursing in the perfection of wisdom. This is the coursing that thoroughly knows all objects of observation for a bodhisattva coursing in the perfection of wisdom, and it is the coursing that utterly destroys all objects of observation.

When a bodhisattva subdued by supreme power courses in this way, he does not course in the observation of the purity of form. Likewise, he does not course in the observation of the purity of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation of form is, by its very nature, pure. Whatever such coursing there is, that is the coursing of a bodhisattva in the perfection of wisdom.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of the eye. He does not course in the observation of the purity of the ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation, up through mind, is, by its very nature, pure. Whatever such coursing there is, that is the coursing of a bodhisattva in the perfection of wisdom.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of form, sound, smell, taste, tangible objects, and phenomena. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation, up through phenomena, is, by its very nature, pure. Whatever such coursing there is, that is the coursing of a bodhisattva in the perfection of wisdom.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of name and form. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation of name and form is, by its

very nature, pure. Whatever such coursing there is, that is the coursing of a bodhisattva in the perfection of wisdom.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of self and sentient being. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation of self and sentient being is, by its very nature, pure. Whatever such coursing there is, that is the coursing of a bodhisattva in the perfection of wisdom.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of life force, elements, person, agent, instigator of action, one who stirs, one who thoroughly stirs, experiencer, one who causes experience, and view. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that life force, elements, person, agent, instigator of action, one who stirs, one who thoroughly stirs, experiencer, and...

one who causes to experience, and view — the observation of these is, by its very nature, thoroughly known to be pure. Whatever such coursing there is, that is the coursing of a bodhisattva in the perfection of wisdom.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of obscurations. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation of obscurations is, by its very nature, pure.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of dependent origination. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation of dependent origination is, by its very nature, pure.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation of the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm is, by its very nature, pure.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of moral discipline and corrupt moral discipline. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation of moral discipline and corrupt moral discipline is, by its very nature, pure.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of patience and malice, diligence and

laziness, meditative concentration and distraction, wisdom and corrupt wisdom. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation of patience and malice, diligence and laziness, meditative concentration and distraction, wisdom and corrupt wisdom is, by its very nature, pure.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of the past, the future, and the present. Why is that? Because he thoroughly knows that the observation of the past, the future, and the present is, by its very nature, pure.

A bodhisattva mahāsattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of the unobstructed. Why is that? Because he knows that the observation of the unobstructed is, by its very nature, pure.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of the superknowledges. Why is that? Because he knows that the observation of the superknowledges is, by its very nature, pure.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way does not course in the observation of the purity of omniscience. Why is that? Because he knows that the observation of omniscience is, by its very nature, pure.

A bodhisattva subdued by supreme power who courses in this way courses in the perfection of wisdom. He does not course in any pure observation whatsoever.

Since name and form are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since dependent origination is inconceivable, and since affliction in its entirety is inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since the ripening of karma is inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since error is inconceivable, and since views are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since the desire realm is inconceivable, and since the form realm and the formless realm are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since the self is inconceivable, sentient beings are inconceivable, generosity is inconceivable, miserliness is inconceivable, moral discipline is inconceivable, corrupt discipline is inconceivable, patience is inconceivable, malice is inconceivable, diligence is inconceivable, laziness is inconceivable, meditative concentration is inconceivable, distraction is inconceivable, wisdom is inconceivable, and corrupt wisdom is inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since attachment, aversion, and delusion are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since the applications of mindfulness are inconceivable, and the correct forms of abandonment, the unmistakable factors, the immeasurables, and the bases of miraculous power are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is also inconceivable.

Since the faculties, the powers, the branches of awakening, meditative absorption, and the meditative attainments are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since suffering, its origin, its cessation, and the path are inconceivable, this perfection of wisdom of the bodhisattva is inconceivable.

Since knowledge and liberation are inconceivable, and the knowledge of exhaustion, the knowledge of non-arising, and the knowledge of non-application are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since the grounds of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since the qualities of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Since the superknowledges are inconceivable, and the past, the future, and the present are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Fascicle Five.

Since unobstructed wisdom is inconceivable, and nirvāṇa is inconceivable, and the qualities of a buddha are inconceivable, this practice of the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom is inconceivable.

Why is this so?

It is not the practice of those belonging to the vehicle of solitary buddhas (pratyekabuddhas). Sudṛḍhavikramin, if this practice should indeed become the practice of those belonging to the vehicle of hearers (śrāvakas) or of those belonging to the vehicle of solitary buddhas, then for them even the very designations "one belonging to the vehicle of hearers" or "one belonging to the vehicle of solitary buddhas" would cease to exist at all, and they would instead become bodhisattvas, and they would become Tathāgatas who have attained the four fearlessnesses. But since this is not so, Sudṛḍhavikramin, this practice conducted in this way does not belong to those of the vehicle of hearers, nor does it belong to those of the vehicle of solitary buddhas. Therefore they are not counted among those called bodhisattvas, nor do they become Tathāgatas who have attained the four fearlessnesses.

Sudṛḍhavikramin, this practice of engaging in the Perfection of Wisdom is itself the ground of fearlessness. Sudṛḍhavikramin, bodhisattvas who practice in this way, even though they have not yet become fully and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, will swiftly attain the four fearlessnesses through the power of their aspirations and through the power of the blessing of the buddhas, the blessed ones.

Sudṛḍhavikramin, those belonging to the vehicle of hearers and those belonging to the vehicle of solitary buddhas do not have the four fearlessnesses; the Tathāgatas do not bless them with the four fearlessnesses either. Sudṛḍhavikramin, that ground through the power of whose aspiration one comes to attain the four fearlessnesses is the bodhisattva ground. Why is this so? Sudṛḍhavikramin, it is because bodhisattvas of the Perfection of Wisdom come to attain the four kinds of individual perfect knowledge. What are these four? They are: individual perfect knowledge of meaning, individual perfect knowledge of Dharma, individual perfect knowledge of terms and definitions, and individual perfect knowledge of eloquence. Those who possess these four, even though not yet fully and completely awakened, thoroughly hold the four fearlessnesses through the power of aspiration. The Tathāgata, too, knowing that they possess roots of virtue and knowing that they have also attained the ground of the Perfection of Wisdom, blesses them with the four fearlessnesses.

Sudṛḍhavikramin, therefore, if one wishes to attain the bodhisattva's four kinds of individual perfect knowledge, and wishes to swiftly become skilled in the four fearlessnesses, one should train in the Perfection of Wisdom and put it into practice.

Sudṛḍhāvīkramin, furthermore, the bodhisattva who practices the Perfection of Wisdom thoroughly understands the cause, origin, cessation, and ending of all phenomena, and therefore does not apply any phenomenon at all to the Perfection of Wisdom. Because he thoroughly understands the cause, origin, cessation, path, and defining characteristic of all phenomena, he neither cultivates nor fails to cultivate form. Likewise, he neither cultivates nor fails to cultivate feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. He neither cultivates nor fails to cultivate name and form. He neither cultivates nor fails to cultivate affliction and purification. He neither cultivates nor fails to cultivate error, obscuration, and views that have arisen. He neither cultivates nor fails to cultivate attachment, aversion, and delusion. He neither cultivates nor fails to cultivate the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm. And with regard to the realm of sentient beings, and...

Thus ends the teaching on the Perfection of Wisdom set forth in The Noble One's Questions of Suvikrāntavikrāmin.

This was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptors Śīlendrabodhi and Jinamitra together with the chief editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, who also revised it according to the new terminology.

Translator's Notes

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at "Why is this?" (ཇུག་གི་ཡིན་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟོས་པ་), which is the natural end point of the supplied text; the answer would follow in subsequent material not included here.
- The passage is cut off mid-sentence at the end (on "the suchness that is not other, and..."), matching the source text's incompleteness. The phrase "rab kyi rtsal gyis rnam par gnon pa" (rendered here as "Its power thoroughly subdues") functions as a recurring refrain in this text whose precise syntactic connection to what precedes and follows is somewhat elliptical in the Tibetan; it has been rendered to preserve the parallel structure while remaining faithful to the literal sense of a supreme, overpowering force or capacity.
- The list of pseudo-selves (self, sentient being, life-force, nourisher, person, individual, one born of another, offspring, agent, etc.) reflects a standard enumeration of wrong views of personal identity found in Prajñāpāramitā sūtras; terms are rendered literally to preserve the traditional catalogue rather than smoothing them into synonyms.
- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at "feeling, perception, formations, and..." (presumably continuing with "consciousness"), consistent with the source text ending there. Śāradvatīputra is an alternate name for Śāriputra used once in the source; both refer to the same interlocutor.
- The term rendered "unmixed qualities of a buddha" (Skt. āveṇika buddhadharma) refers to the eighteen distinctive attributes exclusive to buddhas; this is a standard Prajñāpāramitā list. The long string of terms for "person" (self, sentient being, life-force, etc.) reflects the classical enumeration of wrong views of selfhood being negated throughout the sūtra.
- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source (on "cessation, and..."), evidently continuing

with "the path" (lam) in the untranslated portion; this has been left as is per the given text boundary.

- The term རྒྱུ་གྲོལ་བཤམས་པ་ ("become a mu-steps / tīrthika for beings") here is used in its literal etymological sense of "ford" or "crossing point" (a place of access to the water), not in the pejorative sectarian sense of "non-Buddhist adherent" found elsewhere in this glossary; I have rendered it as "guide" with a parenthetical note for clarity, since translating it as "tīrthika" would wrongly suggest the sectarian meaning in this context. Śāradvatīputra is another name for Śāriputra; both forms appear in the source text and are preserved as given.
- The passage is cut off mid-sentence at the end (ending with "རྒྱུ་གྲོལ་བཤམས་པ་"), which I have rendered as an incomplete final clause to match the source. The term "rab kyi rtsal gyis rnam par gnon pa" (here rendered "subdued by supreme power") likely refers to a bodhisattva's name or epithet in this sūtra context (possibly corresponding to a Sanskrit compound such as "paramabalavikramin" or similar), though the precise proper-name status could not be fully confirmed without broader context from the source sūtra.
- The term རྒྱུ་གྲོལ་བཤམས་པ་ ("unobstructed" / "unimpeded") likely refers to unobstructed cognition or unobstructed knowledge (an epithet sometimes applied to a buddha's unhindered wisdom); rendered generically as "the unobstructed" since the specific referent is not further specified in this passage.
- The passage lists a long series of paired categories, each said to be "inconceivable" (bsam gyis mi khyab pa), followed by the refrain that the bodhisattva's practice of the perfection of wisdom is likewise inconceivable. The structure is highly formulaic and repetitive in the source; this has been preserved faithfully. "Fascicle Five" (bam po lnga pa) marks a traditional section division in the manuscript and has been rendered as a simple heading-like phrase within the flowing text, as is standard for such markers. The final line "Why is this so?" opens into what would be the following explanatory passage, not included here.
- The passage is addressed to a bodhisattva named Sudṛḍhavikramin ("rab kyi rtsal gyis rnam par gnon pa" — "Firmly Overpowering by Supreme Might/Force"), reconstructed here as a proper name based on context; the Tibetan is a vocative address repeated throughout. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text ("sentient beings' realm and..."), reflecting the excerpt's cutoff point.
- The title "Suvikrāntavikrāmin" (Rab kyi rtsal gyis rnam par gnon pa) is reconstructed from the Tibetan; it names the questioner, a bodhisattva figure, whose full title would be "The Noble One's [Sūtra of] the Questions of Suvikrāntavikrāmin."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.